

**SEMINAR SUMMARY:
MARCH 17, 2026 - CHENG LY
EARNING A PH.D.**

ROB TOMPKINS

We began the lecture talking about Neuroscience and talking about how the nervous system is electrical in nature. Clearly our nervous system has something electrical going on with it, because for example defibrillators rely on the application of a voltage potential to help reset the heart. We then looked at another example where only electrical stimuli are harnessed in a way as to control a robotic apparatus (an arm for example). So not only are electrical potentials used for bodily regulation, they are in fact used in all facets of both the somatic and autonomic nervous system (willful control versus involuntary functions).

After the introduction of the electrical nature of the nervous system, we went into discussing various different collaborators of the student variety that Dr. Ly had. The list was extensive and across various institutions which was the most impressive bit of it all. Furthermore, there was a good representation of all different types of students from undergraduates to Ph.D students.